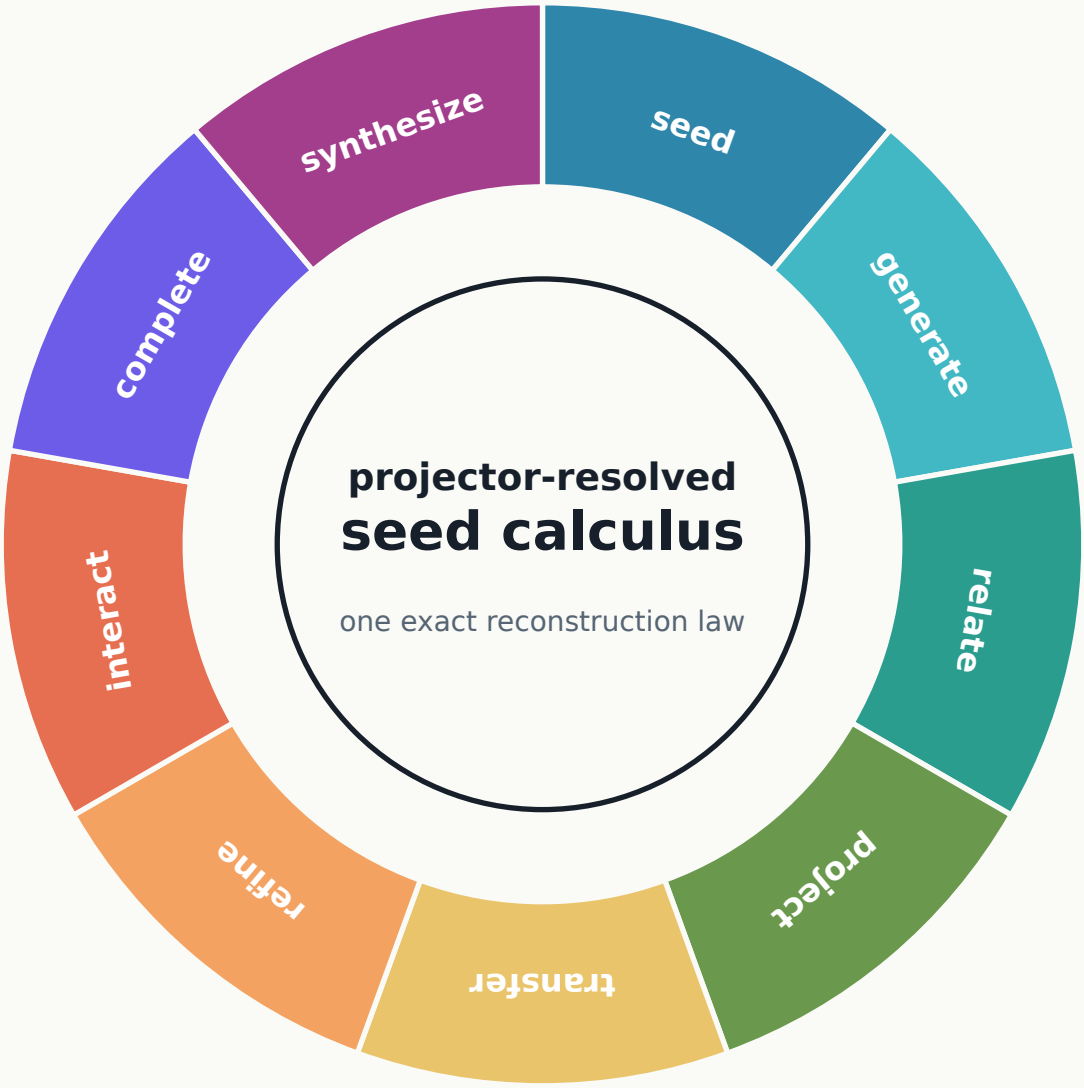The complete operational cycle